

Pouya Kia

Data Engineer

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Summary

Data Engineer with 5+ years across data engineering and data science, including 3+ years building production data systems in fintech and payments. Builds Python and SQL pipelines and data marts for analytics and machine learning, with experience processing over 2 TB daily at Asan Pardakht and maintaining Airflow workflows, data validation, and failure monitoring at Bitex.

Skills

Programming and transformation: Python, SQL, dbt, ETL/ELT, incremental and batch pipelines

Data modeling and quality: Dimensional modeling, Kimball, Data Vault, data marts, data validation, dbt tests, data lineage

Orchestration and processing: Apache Airflow, Kafka, Spark

Cloud and storage: GCP, Cloud Storage, Pub/Sub, BigQuery, AWS, Amazon S3, ClickHouse

Databases: PostgreSQL, MariaDB, MongoDB

Development and operations: Git, GitLab, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, pipeline monitoring and failure alerting

Analytics and ML: Feature pipelines, XGBoost, RNN, Power BI

Work Experience

LandedCity

Istanbul, Türkiye

Founder & Senior Data Engineer

2026/04 - Present

An expat intelligence platform with country-specific guidance and AI-powered tools.

- Led the platform's technical architecture and implementation using AWS, Kafka, and ClickHouse for data ingestion, event-driven processing, and analytical queries.
- Worked on data-lake architecture involving lakeFS; built crawlers to collect relocation information and prepare it for downstream processing.
- Developed preparation and indexing workflows for a ChromaDB knowledge base containing 305 records across five countries.
- Connected the knowledge base to a source-backed AI assistant for country-specific questions.
- Designed and implemented Python REST APIs for document analysis, legal and immigration Q&A, saved calculations, document-checking flows, rate limiting, and AI-service integrations.

Bitex

Tehran, Iran

Senior Data Engineer

2025/02 - 2026/03

An OTC online exchange for trading cryptocurrency.

- Designed and maintained Airflow DAGs for an incremental market-data pipeline running every three hours. Wrote Python code to extract MongoDB data, transform and validate it, and load it into PostgreSQL staging tables.
- Built transaction-derived rules and features from buy, sell, and withdrawal data for fraud and risk monitoring, including historical withdrawal thresholds, unusually large trades, rolling transaction counts, and withdrawals shortly after trading.
- Built a Kafka pipeline delivering transaction, login, and device data to a feature store for production fraud detection.
- Compared market prices from two MongoDB sources in Python, matching records within a ± 2 -second timestamp tolerance and correcting mismatched priceTMN values.
- Added final-failure alerts and Airflow scheduler checks; investigated failed tasks, fixed PostgreSQL connection and provider issues, and reran affected workflows.
- Reduced lock contention in Airflow ETL and PostgreSQL reporting workflows using temporary-table swaps, index tuning, and query-plan changes.
- Built incremental MariaDB-to-PostgreSQL pipelines with server-side cursors, preventing memory exhaustion and connection timeouts during multi-million-row transfers.

- Led a MongoDB-to-MariaDB migration and schema redesign, improving query performance by 30% and supporting 50% more traffic.
- Used Git and GitLab branches, local testing, and the repository’s merge/review workflow to manage changes before deployment; standardized deployments with Docker Compose, Kubernetes, and CI/CD.

Asan Pardakht

Tehran, Iran

Data Engineer

2023/06 - 2025/01

- A leading payment service provider in Iran, processing millions of daily transactions across digital payment and wallet services.*
- Built batch and real-time pipelines processing over 2 TB daily with Kafka, Spark, Airflow, Cloud Storage, and Pub/Sub on GCP.
 - Developed and maintained 5+ data marts using Kimball, Data Vault, dbt, and Airflow for analytics, reporting, and machine-learning use cases.
 - Implemented SQL lineage structures, cutoff controls, data validation, and dbt tests across payment-data workflows.
 - Used Amazon S3 for data storage alongside work on the GCP-based data platform.
 - Containerized ETL and analytics workloads with Docker and Kubernetes and integrated them into GitHub Actions CI/CD.

Asan Pardakht

Tehran, Iran

Data Scientist

2023/01 - 2023/05

- Defined and tracked KPIs across 10 million daily transactions to support payment analytics.
- Developed next-best-action and churn models with XGBoost, reaching 92% accuracy, increasing engagement by 10%, and reducing churn by 18%.
- Built RNN forecasting services for 50M+ users, achieving over 90% precision to support product decisions.

Otaghak

Tehran, Iran

Data Scientist

2021/01 - 2022/01

- An online travel and accommodation booking platform.*
- Built a recommendation system using tree-based models and matrix factorization, increasing conversions by 65%.
 - Deployed customer-behavior models, leading to a 19% increase in engagement.
 - Used RFM segmentation to develop targeted marketing strategies, contributing to a 10% sales increase.
 - Built a Power BI dashboard that improved operational efficiency by 25%.

Dayche Group

Tehran, Iran

Junior Data Scientist

2020/01 - 2020/12

- A consulting and project-based technology services company delivering data, analytics, and software-related projects for clients.*
- Integrated a Python OCR pipeline that accelerated data processing by 40%.
 - Analyzed more than 10,000 lung images with OpenCV and scikit-image, achieving 95% diagnostic accuracy in infection detection.
 - Contributed to predictive models that improved sales efficiency by 8%.

Education

University of Tehran

Tehran, Iran

Master of Science - Industrial Engineering (Optimize systems)

2017 - 2021

Qom University of Technology

Qom, Iran

Bachelor of Science - Telecommunication Engineering

2012 - 2016

Languages

Persian (Native) | English (C1)